Kanban Cadences

Set a rhythm of short, focused meetings that keep work flowing and services improving, with or without iterations.

Manage Flow · Inspired by the Kanban Method (David J. Anderson) · Feedback Loops · Replenishment

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

TEAM / SERVICE: Store Platform

DATE: 15 May

1 Our Cadences

TYPICAL TIMINGS SHOWN · ADAPT TO YOUR CONTEXT · TICK THE ONES YOU'LL RUN

☑ Daily Kanban Meeting

Daily · 15 min

Walk the board, unblock work, decide what to finish today.

When: 09:15, at the board
Who: the whole team
Inputs → outputs: board → today's focus

☑ Replenishment

Weekly · 30–60 min

Choose which options to pull into the system next.

When: Mondays, 10:00
Who: lead + requesting teams
Inputs → outputs: requests → items pulled

☑ Delivery Planning

Per delivery · 30 min

Decide what's ready to hand over to customers, and when.

When: before each release
Who: team + on-call
Inputs → outputs: done work → release plan

☑ Service Delivery Review

Every 2 weeks · 45 min

Check flow and service levels against what customers expect.

When: every other Thursday
Who: team + Checkout, Basket
Inputs → outputs: metrics → one improvement

☑ Operations Review

Monthly · 60 min

Look across services for shared problems and capacity.

When: monthly
Who: all platform teams
Inputs → outputs: capacity → shared fixes

☐ Risk Review

Monthly · 30 min

Review blockers and risks that threaten delivery.

When: –
Who: –
Inputs → outputs: folded into operations review

☑ Strategy Review

Quarterly · 1–2 h

Check direction, services and investment still fit the goals.

When: quarterly
Who: leads + Head of Digital
Inputs → outputs: goals → investment mix

☑ Our Own Cadence

Add a review your team needs.

When: monthly: cloud cost review
Who: team + Finance
Inputs → outputs: the bill → savings to try

2 Replenishment

WHAT DO WE PULL IN NEXT?

Space available (WIP limit minus items in progress): 5 – 3 = 2

How we choose: cost of delay first, then the oldest request

Options waiting

- Log retention change
- New staging per team
- Cost alerts
- Upgrade the database

Pulled in, and why

ITEM	WHY NOW
Monitoring dashboards	two incidents went unseen last month
Faster test environment	blocking Basket's test data

3 Service Delivery Review

ARE WE MEETING EXPECTATIONS?

MEASURE	EXPECTATION / SLE	ACTUAL	ACTION
Lead time (85th percentile)	5 days	7 days	split big requests
Throughput per week	8 a week	7	–
Items past their SLE	0	3	swarm on the oldest first
Blocked time	under 10%	15%	track waits on vendors
Customer satisfaction	4 out of 5	3.8	ask Checkout what's missing
Our own measure	cost per order £0.04	£0.05	the cost review

Top improvement to try: swarm on anything past its SLE before pulling new work

"Which conversation would most improve our flow if we had it regularly?"

"Are we meeting what our customers expect, and how do we know?"

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